



Hackwell 2.0 Prelims Rubrics

Official jury scoring guide for the Preliminary Round



About the Prelims

In the Prelims round, every team submits a PDF covering their problem, solution, methodology, and impact, then walks the jury through a live prototype demo.

The goal isn't a finished product — it's identifying teams with a well-understood problem, a sound technical approach, and real, working progress worth advancing to the finals.

This guide covers the six scoring criteria, what each one checks for, and why it carries its weight — keeping scoring consistent across every team and panel.

Evaluation Criteria

Teams are scored out of 100 across six criteria. Roughly half the score is weighted toward the prototype itself, since Prelims is meant to reward genuine working progress, not just a strong pitch.

#	Criteria	Description (Jury Hint)	Max Score
1	Concept Strength	Problem relevance, research depth, originality & feasibility of the idea	15
2	Technical Approach	Methodology, tech stack choice & soundness of system design	15
3	Innovation & Differentiation	Novelty of the solution, creative implementation & distinction from existing approaches	15
4	Prototype Implementation	Working prototype, core functionality & completeness of what's actually been built	20
5	Prototype Delivery & Stability	Does the live demo run end-to-end without breaking — reliability, responsiveness, execution on the day	20
6	Live Defense & Communication	Technical Q&A depth, ownership of work, pitch clarity & visible contribution from multiple members	15
TOTAL			100

Criteria Explained

What each criterion checks for and what juries should look for.

1. Concept Strength (15 marks)

Is the problem real, specific, and backed by evidence — not just assumed?

- A clearly defined problem and user group, not a generic pain point
- Some research or data behind it, not just assertion
- An idea that is realistic to build at hackathon scale

2. Technical Approach (15 marks)

Does the proposed tech stack and architecture actually fit the problem?

- Tools chosen for a reason, not trend-driven (AI/blockchain without justification)
- A logical, end-to-end system design — not just a feature list
- Evidence the team understands how their own system works

3. Innovation & Differentiation (15 marks)

What does this solution do differently from what already exists?

- A clear, meaningful USP — not a cosmetic twist on an existing idea
- Creative use or combination of techniques
- A difference that matters to the end user

4. Prototype Implementation (20 marks)

How much of the core idea is genuinely functional right now?

- The central feature — the one the idea depends on — actually works
- No hardcoded outputs or faked data standing in for real functionality
- Completeness matters more than visual polish at this stage

5. Prototype Delivery & Stability (20 marks)

How does it perform live, in front of the jury, right now?

- Full demo flow completes without crashing or freezing
- Reasonable speed and responsiveness during the walkthrough
- Nothing has to be 'imagined' because it didn't work on the day

6. Live Defense & Communication (15 marks)

Can the team explain and defend their own work, clearly and together?

- Confident, honest answers under questioning — no bluffing on gaps
- A clear, well-timed pitch
- More than one member able to speak to the work